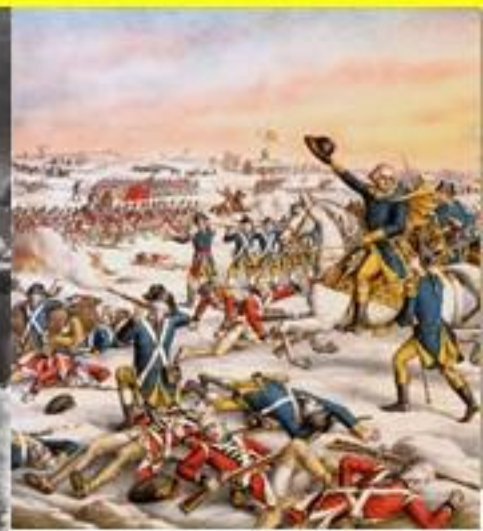


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 27

FIRST WORLD WAR - 2

WHAT WAS THE IMMEDIATE CAUSE OF WORLD WAR-I?

ASSASSINATION OF ARCH DUKE FRANCIS FERDINAND AND HIS WIFE

- 1** The immediate cause was the assassination of Arch Duke Francis Ferdinand who was heir to the Austrian throne.
- 2** Arch Duke Francis Ferdinand and his wife were assassinated by Serbians in the Bosnian capital Sarajevo when they paid a visit to this city on 28th June 1914.
- 3** The news of this murder shocked many countries
- 4** Austria-Hungary was already sick of Serbia and she decided to take advantage of the new situation to crush her.



WHAT WAS THE IMMEDIATE CAUSE OF WORLD WAR-I?

ASSASSINATION OF ARCH DUKE FRANCIS FERDINAND AND HIS WIFE

- 5** The murder of their crown prince and his wife resulted in an ultimatum being sent to Serbia for immediate compliance of certain terms.
- 6** Serbia's reply did not pacify Austria-Hungary.
- 7** Hence, Austria-Hungary backed by Germany declared war on Serbia.
- 8** Russia mobilised her forces in favour of Serbia.



WHAT IS THE ACTUAL COURSE OF THE WAR?

- 1 Central Powers:**
 - During the war Germany and her allies were called Central Powers.
- 2 Allied Powers:**
 - England and her allies were called Allied Powers.
- 3** Germany entered the war to defend Austria.
- 4** Shortly all the powers in the hostile camps were automatically drawn into the war.
- 5** Turkey and Bulgaria joined the war on the side of Germany.



WHAT IS THE ACTUAL COURSE OF THE WAR?

- 6 Italy left the Triple Alliance and joined the opposite camp with the idea of recovering Italian territories under Austrian control.
- 7 England joined the war against Germany.
- 8 There was bitter fighting on the French soil.
- 9 The Battle of Verdun decided the fortunes of the war in favour of the Allies.
- 10 Germany started submarine warfare in a large scale. All the laws relating to naval warfare were thrown out.



WHAT IS THE ACTUAL COURSE OF THE WAR?

11 Brest-Litovsk Treaty:

- Russia fought on the side of Allies up to 1917.
- The Bolshevik regime wanted peace with Germany.
- Thus the Brest-Litovsk Treaty was signed between Russia and Germany.



12 The Lusitania ship:

- The Lusitania ship was drowned by a German submarine and consequently many Americans lost their lives.
- This resulted in the declaration of war against Germany by the U.S.A.



WHAT IS THE ACTUAL COURSE OF THE WAR?

13 Germany's Surrender:

- a** In spite of best efforts, Germany could not stand and ultimately she surrendered in November 1918.
- b** The German Emperor Kaiser William lost all hopes of winning the war. He abdicated his throne and fled to Holland.
- c** The German army signed the armistice agreement on November 11, 1918 to mark their surrender to the Allies.
- d** The allies of Germany had earlier suffered defeat at the hands of the Allied powers.



WHAT ARE THE RESULTS OF THE WAR?

I SOCIAL

- In the war millions of soldiers and civilians lost their life. Thousands became crippled or disabled.
- Since male members died in large numbers which created serious issues like:

1 A large variety of deadly weapons such as incendiary bombs, grenades and poison gases were used. Tanks, submarines and aircrafts were also used.

2 The Great War took a heavy toll of lives. It is estimated that about ten million lives were lost and twenty million people have been wounded.



WHAT ARE THE RESULTS OF THE WAR?

I SOCIAL

- 3 People all over the world suffered untold miseries.
- 4 Thousands of families were devoid of their primary bread earners.
- 5 Many young women became widows which resulted into serious family disharmonies.
- 6 The male-female ratio in the society got skewed.



II ECONOMIC

- On the economic front the impact of the war was horrendous.
- Economies in Europe got affected by the war in the following ways:

1 There was a large scale damage to civil property. There was unprecedented loss to infrastructural assets like dams, bridges, roads, railways etc., which proved detrimental for industries and trade.

2 It is estimated that the direct cost of the war reached just over two hundred billion dollars and the indirect cost more than a hundred and fifty billion dollars

3 The war wrought its havoc on the economics of the participating countries. It may be remembered that about 25 nations had joined the allies at the time of the outbreak of war.



II ECONOMIC

- 4 The victors felt the devastating effects of the war even before the cessation. All these nations were burdened with the national debts. The world economy was in shambles.
- 5 During war as maximum attention was given to produce the war material therefore the production of essential commodities received a serious setback.
- 6 This resulted into the acute shortages and scarcities of essential commodities.
- 7 There was a decline in purchasing power of the people as a result the price of the goods went down considerable after the war.
- 8 This squeezed the profits of the manufacturing units which resulted into unemployment. Millions of people in Europe lost their jobs.
- 9 Defeated nations were forced to pay exorbitant war damages which further deteriorated their economies.



III POLITICAL

- The political impact of First world produced a formidable change in the geopolitics of Europe and the World.
- The following were the most important political implications of the First World War:

1 The rule of the three oldest dynasties in Europe i.e., Romanov in Russia, Hohenzollern in Germany and Hapsburg in Austria was thrown away after the First World War.

2 While Germany and Austria adopted democratic constitution, the revolution in Russia marked the victory of communism and socialism.

3 Before First World War, monarchy was the most popular form of the government in Europe. However, after the war the ideals were democracy and nationalism gained impetus.



III POLITICAL

- 4 These ideals were not just confined to the soil of Europe, but also to the colonial people. The freedom movements in various colonies got intensified after the first World War.
- 5 The political arrangements that were accepted after the First World war adhered in principle to the tenet of nationalism.
- 6 Although practically the vested interest of the powerful victors of the war gained prominence over the mandate of people at various instances. Thus after the war Hungary, Poland, Yugoslavia and Czechoslovakia gained independence.
- 7 After the First World War, United states of America became a major player in international politics and diplomacy.



IV TREATIES WITH CENTRAL POWER

1 Treaty of Versailles:

- Germany was forced to sign the Treaty of Versailles on 28th June 1919.
- It was a dictated peace and Germany had by then become even too weak to protest.
- She lost everything. Germany and her allies suffered most since they had to pay heavy sums to the victorious allies as reparation debts.



2 Treaty of St. Germaine:

- Austria Hungary signed the Treaty of St. Germaine.



IV TREATIES WITH CENTRAL POWER

3 Treaty of Trianon:

- Hungary signed the Treaty of Trianon with the allies in 1920.

4 Treaty of Neuilly:

- Bulgaria had accepted the Treaty of Neuilly in 1919.

5 Treaty of Sevres:

- Turkey, which sided with Germany during the war, signed the Treaty of Sevres in 1920.



QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. Enumerate the various causes of the First World War.
150 words
2. Enumerate the implications of First World War.
250 words
3. Evaluate the relative importance of imperialism, the arms race and the failure of diplomacy in causing the First World War.
150 words
4. Rise of militarism in Europe culminated into First World War.
Elucidate.
150 Words

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